



FROM PURPOSE TO IMPACT

NASWAP Program & Student Impact Report

5 YEAR REVIEW

CONNECT. COLLABORATE. CREATE IMPACT.



A nonprofit built around student ownership.

Our mission is to cultivate a community of purpose-driven students who are committed to developing their skills and passions to create meaningful change while preparing for successful careers after graduation.



WWW.STUDENTSWITHAPURPOSE.ORG

What makes our model distinctive is what students do with the support: they research community needs, design and lead initiatives, build community based partnerships, reflect on outcomes, and carry that work into new academic, professional, and community opportunities.

PURPOSE

Students connect their personal motivation, values and lived experiences to a real-world issue they care about, helping them define why the issue matters and the kind of change they want to contribute.

EXPERIENTIAL LEARNING

Students move course based knowledge into community-based leadership and hands on experience.

INTERDISCIPLINARY COMMUNITY

Students get the opportunity to work across majors, backgrounds, institutions, and perspectives.

PROFESSIONAL PREPARATION

Students build and strengthen their research, communication, leadership, project management, presentation, and stakeholder communication skills.



RESEARCH-INFORMED LEADERSHIP. STUDENT-BUILT IMPACT.

IMPACT AT A GLANCE

142

EVENTS
HOSTED IN
THE LAST
FIVE YEARS.



82%

OF ATTENDEES
CAME FROM
OUTSIDE
CHAPTER
MEMBERSHIP



52%

OF EVENTS
INVOLVED DIRECT
WORK WITH
A LOCAL
COMMUNITY
PARTNER



7,100

STUDENTS REACHED
ACROSS NASWAP
EVENTS & PROGRAMS



97%

OF ATTENDEES
WERE SATISFIED
WITH THEIR
EVENT
EXPERIENCE



63%

OF STUDENT
LEADERS
PRESENTED AT
CONFERENCES
BEYOND CAMPUS.



AN INTERDISCIPLINARY COMMUNITY OF STUDENTS

NASWAP Programming is designed to create multiple entry points: students can attend a social event, join a workshop, contribute to an initiative, step into leadership, or move into research and external opportunities. NASWAP's hybrid and virtual options also create access for online students, commuter students, students balancing work or family responsibilities, and students who want to collaborate beyond their home campus. NASWAP also offers hybrid and remote internships that allow students to contribute to national projects, support student chapters, and collaborate with peers and community partners across institutions.

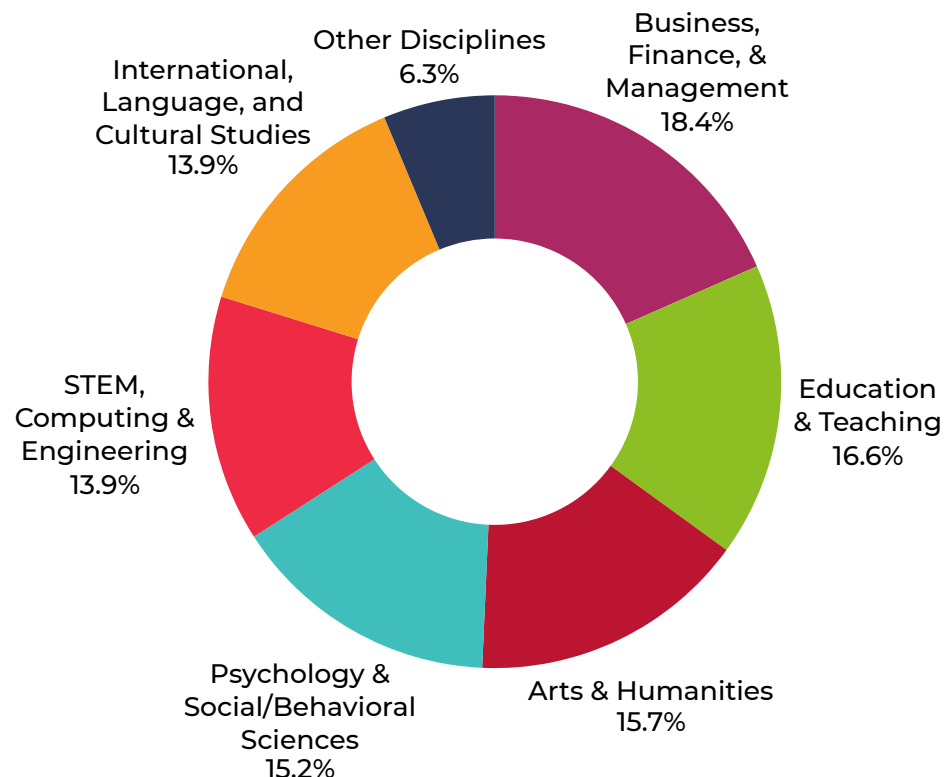
Among non-member sign ins, 30% expressed interest in joining their SWAP chapter after attending student designed initiative events.

NASWAP programming serves not only existing members, but also students encountering NASWAP programming for the first time.

No single broad academic area represents even 20% of students. With no single discipline dominating, NASWAP serves a broad mix of students across campus and beyond.

**Other disciplines include Environmental & Sustainability Studies, Communication & Media Studies, and Health & Human Services.*

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WHAT PARTICIPANTS EXPERIENCED

PRACTICAL LEARNING

Scholarships, grants, internships, research, communication, conflict management, nonprofit systems, sustainability, and student resources.

CONNECTION & BELONGING

Authentic discussion, approachable speakers, meaningful mentorship, peer connection, and a welcoming environment.

DEMAND FOR MORE

Follow-up workshops, deeper topic exploration, more interaction, and continued professional development.

FLEXIBLE ACCESS

Virtual, hybrid, and in-person formats help students participate in workshops, mentoring, leadership development, and community-connected programming in ways that fit their schedules and locations.

OVERALL EVENT SATISFACTION



97% of participants rated that they were either satisfied or very satisfied with their event/program experience.

SESSION CONTENT



96.6% of participants found content useful, engaging, and well developed.

RELEVANCE & HELPFULNESS



93.5% of participants found events/programming applicable to academic, professional, or personal development.

LOGISTICS



91% of participants rated communication, organization, timing, format, platform, or venue positively.

MULTIDISCIPLINARY. SHARED

FROM INSIGHT TO ACTION

Students identify a community need, explore the insight through research and community conversation, design an initiative, build partnerships, lead events or experiential service learning experiences, and assess the impact of their collective efforts.



EXPLORE



BUILD



CREATE



ASSESS



STUDENT INITIATIVE AREAS HAVE EXPLORED:

SUSTAINABLE ACTION

Reducing waste, repairing, recycling, and supporting EV tech infrastructure.

CIVIC ENGAGEMENT

Increasing voter participation and understanding public issues.

ADVOCACY & AWARENESS

Addressing human trafficking, equity, access, and community well-being.

COMMUNITY CARE

Supporting inclusion, mental health, and local service oriented organizations.

CAMPUS & COMMUNITY COLLABORATION

Bringing campus resources and community expertise together.

PURPOSE. COMMUNITY IMPACT.



PARTNERSHIP ECOSYSTEM

Partnerships with campus offices, nonprofits, businesses, civic groups, government agencies, and community organizations help students connect campus learning with real community relationships, experiences, and opportunities.

This work strengthens and extends existing community engagement efforts on campus, by helping students move between these resources with greater clarity, confidence, and purpose.

PARTNERSHIPS HELP STUDENTS:

LEARN FROM
AND APPLY
COMMUNITY
EXPERTISE

ENGAGE REAL
ISSUES IN
AUTHENTIC
SETTINGS.

BUILD
MENTORSHIP AND
PROFESSIONAL
NETWORKS.

ACCESS
OPPORTUNITIES
THAT EXTEND
BEYOND CAMPUS

TURN SHARED
IDEAS INTO
VISIBLE ACTION.

LEADERSHIP STARTS BEFORE THE EVENTS

Initiative-Building for Meaningful Purpose, Action, Community, and Thought (IMPACT) Leadership Institute

FROM IDEA-BASED TO EVIDENCE-BASED LEADERSHIP

IMPACT is NASWAP's 7-week virtual leadership development experience for student leaders. Before launching initiatives during the academic year, students go through the initiative and learn how to clarify their purpose, research community needs, test assumptions, develop strategies, and prepare to lead with greater intention.

Since IMPACT is virtual, students from partner campuses, online programs, and different geographic locations can collaborate in a shared national leadership experience.



7 WEEKS

From personal purpose to a launch ready initiative plan.

SELF AWARENESS

Students become clearer about their values, motivations, leadership, identity, and communities they hope to serve.



COMMUNITY INQUIRY

Students learn to look beyond assumptions by researching needs, assets, barriers, and perspectives before deciding what action should look like.



STRATEGIC LEADERSHIP

Students balance creativity with planning, accountability, accessibility, teamwork, feasibility, and measurable goals.



REFLECTION & ADAPTATION

Students learn that leadership requires listening, incorporating feedback, evaluating impact, and changing course when needed.



FACILITATE
meetings and conversations.



LISTEN
to community perspectives.



PLAN
with evidence and intention.



COLLABORATE
across people and organizations.



ADAPT
by incorporating feedback.



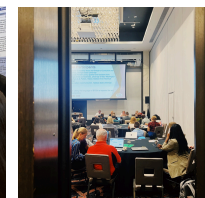
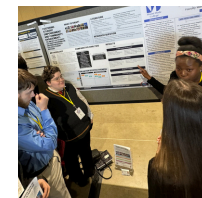
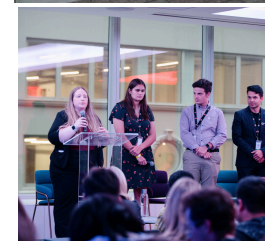
COMMUNICATE
ideas with confidence.

BEYOND THE INITIATIVE

NASWAP's impact does not end after a student has launched their initiative. Students continue to build on what they have learned by presenting their work, participating in hybrid NASWAP internships, attending global, national, and regional conferences, joining leadership summits, and engaging in innovation experiences that expand their perspectives and strengthen their skills. These opportunities open doors, deepen networks, and prepare students to lead with purpose beyond their time at their institution.

63%

OF STUDENT LEADERS PRESENTED AT CONFERENCES BEYOND CAMPUS.



PRESENT

Students share their ideas and research on the national and international stages.



CONNECT

Students build connections and collaborate across communities and cultures.



PREPARE

Students strengthen their skills and confidence for future leadership.



GROW

Students create meaningful impact and open doors to new opportunities.

VALUES IN PRACTICE

LEADERSHIP

OPPORTUNITY

IMPACT

COMMUNITY

PATHWAYS

ENGAGEMENT

Across campuses and communities, students turn their ideas into action. Guided by six core values, they lead with purpose, build meaningful connections, and create impact that lasts.

LEADERSHIP & ENGAGEMENT

Students lead with purpose that lends itself to action.

Through IMPACT, resulting initiatives, and public facing roles, students build confidence, practice teamwork, and learn how to contribute in ways that uplift others



“Being a leader doesn’t have to look the same way for everyone. Being a leader can simply mean pushing outside your comfort zone, taking the first step, and being yourself in a way that impacts the people around you.

-Clarissa M.,
IMPACT 2025

COMMUNITY & OPPORTUNITY

“SWAP for me means my people. SWAP for me means my community. It means empowerment.

-Shatavia H.,
IMPACT 2025

Students build connections and open doors for one another.

Through mentorship, working with community partners, and creating shared experiences, students strengthen belonging while also gaining access to new people, skills, and opportunities that expand their worldview.



PATHWAYS & IMPACT

Students turn learning into action and create meaningful change.

Students research, present, and lead initiatives that connect personal motivation to community needs ultimately building skills, advancing goals, and contributing to what comes next.



“The IMPACT leadership institute helped me turn my ideas into real projects. It helped me take those ideas from thoughts to real-life plans, objectives, and goals.

-Ashley J.,
IMPACT 2025

BE PART OF THE WORK

NASWAP is an ecosystem of students, institutions, and community partners working together.



Your role makes our impact possible.

Local Context. National Perspective.

Since every campus and community has different needs, assets, and challenges, NASWAP initiatives are not intended to look the same across institutions. Through virtual collaboration, students gain national perspective by learning how peers and community partners in other regions identify needs, solve problems, and create locally relevant impact.

To get started, reach out to us today:
support@studentswithapurpose.org

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STUDENTS

Your ideas matter. NASWAP provides the community, tools, and opportunities to help you lead, grow, and make an impact.

- Join a NASWAP Chapter
- Attend events and present at conferences
- Lead and shape a NASWAP initiative
- Apply for IMPACT and pursue research and leadership opportunities
- Apply for NASWAP hybrid/remote internships

INSTITUTIONS

Partner with NASWAP to enrich student experiences, strengthen campus leadership, and expand pathways to success.

- Partner to expand student leadership
- Advance experiential learning and applied research.
- Integrate service learning and community engagement.
- Co-create community-connected programming
- Connect online, center, commuter, and rural students to flexible hybrid/remote NASWAP internship opportunities

COMMUNITY PARTNERS

Your support opens doors and creates real-world experiences that inspire students and strengthen communities.

- Share expertise and mentorship
- Host students for experiences and site visits
- Collaborate on initiatives and events
- Help identify community needs and opportunities.

NASWAP

NATIONAL ASSOCIATION OF STUDENTS WITH A PURPOSE

Shaping tomorrow through civic
innovation. Turning ideas into action.

CONNECT. COLLABORATE. CREATE IMPACT.

<https://www.studentswithapurpose.org/>

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